

USB and a micro-SD card slot is always nice to have. Some of us still like to load up some of the classics on our USB drives and micro-SD cards and jam to them!

Additionally, with the TWS functionality, you also get the luxury of daisy chaining multiple speakers to create a stereo setup, which with this speaker, would be awesome! And, if you are connected using Bluetooth and are worried about the sound quality, then you can stay assured that you will not have to worry much. In addition to SBC and AAC, the speaker also supports LDAC codec.

Natively, the speaker can play the following four audio formats – MP3, WMA, FLAC, and WAV.

Given the popularity of smart assistants, most speakers these days come with support for them. However, this speaker does not have that. One of its closest competitors, Marshall Acton II comes baked in with the support for voice assistant, albeit Amazon's Alexa specifically. I would have personally loved to see that included in the speaker. It is a quality of life addition, which many appreciate.

There's not much that I could find to fit into this section. As I mentioned earlier, the speaker has a limited selection of features. However, those features have been implemented well. And where this speaker shines is what we will talk about next.

PERFORMANCE AND BATTERY LIFE

AIWA RS-X150 Natsukasii Pro lives up to the expectations set by the MI-X330 Meteor in terms of performance, in my opinion. The speaker has a three-driver setup – 5"x1 (woofer) and 2"x2 tweeters. There are louder speakers that you find at this price. However, finding something that sounds as crisp and detailed as the RS-X150 is rare. This is where the speaker gains the most amount of lost ground from the performance section.

We have a selection of tracks that we play when testing Bluetooth

speakers. And, with every track that I played when testing this speaker, I could see heads peeping from across the office to see what monstrosity had walked in. The balance in the bass was shown when I played Uptown Funk and Hump de Bump. The champion-like performance of the speaker, with the balanced mids, shone through when I played Skyfall by Adele. And the speaker's sparkly highs were put to show with utmost pride in tracks like Selkies by Between the Buried and Me.

When pumped to full, the bass was enough to cause the objects around the speaker to rattle. I also tried watching a couple of videos when I was connected to the speaker, and the balanced mids and highs made sure that the vocals were always reproduced with ease and were clear at all times. There was no noticeable latency between the audio and video as well.

If the out of the box, balanced sound, which is our benchmark here at the Digit Test Centre, is not something that you are fond of, then you can adjust the bass and treble on the fly. Whether you are a fan of pop, rock, hip-hop, or some niche genre of music, I am sure with some minor tweaks, you will find the sound signature that is perfect for you! I was also blown away by the connectivity of the speaker. There's a long story how I discovered its range for the first time, but I can tell you this much the speaker was connected to my phone with four walls and a good 30ish feet of distance.

At the maximum volume, there was almost no distortion in the audio, which is also a rare find these days. There are some speakers which perform well up to the 70 per cent mark, but as soon as the audio peaks beyond that mark, there's noticeable distortion. The 60 W sound output of the speaker is enough to fill a large room. And, if you are having to push the speaker to its limits, at max volume levels, then I don't think that will be an issue as well. As for the

battery life, AIWA claims that this speaker can last for 11 to 12 hours at 50 per cent volume. In my time with the speaker, I found that the speaker missed the claimed mark of 11 hours by one hour. It lasted for 10 hours. Now there are a ton of factors that could affect the battery life of the speaker so that you could still get the claimed duration of playback, possibly even higher with this speaker. When the speaker is out of charge, you can juice it up using the USB-C cable that is included in the box.

VERDICT

The AIWA RS-X150 Natsukasii Pro is a great speaker in its own right. AIWA has positioned its speakers as premium offerings in this space, and this speaker stays true to that philosophy. Like its pricier cousin, the MI-X330 Meteor, the speaker boasts great sound quality with a fixed set of well-implemented features. The build quality also adds to the experience of owning the speaker, with control-cluster being the only let-down there.

If you are looking for a hassle-free and great audio experience, then the AIWA RS-X150 Natsukasii Pro should be on the top of your list of considerations. However, if you are looking for a similar experience, with some added features, then the Marshall Acton II should be your choice. And, if you want a middle ground between portability, outdoor use, and features, then Bose SoundLink Revolve+(Series II) and Sony SRS-XP500C should be the speakers that you look at.

–Satvik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Frequency Response: 125 Hz-16KHz | Built-in Mic: YES | Drivers: Triple | TWS technology: Yes | Phone Call: Yes | DSP technology: Yes | Power Output: 60 W | Playback Time: Upto 12 Hours (50% Volume) | Charging Time: 2 Hours Charging Time (100% Volume) | Charging Current: DC 5V / 2A (Type C) | Battery: Built-in Lithium Ion 6000mAh | BT Version: V5.0

CONTACT

Phone: 1800 123 5313 | Email: getintouch@aiwaindia.com | Website: <https://aiwaindia.com/> | Brand: AIWA